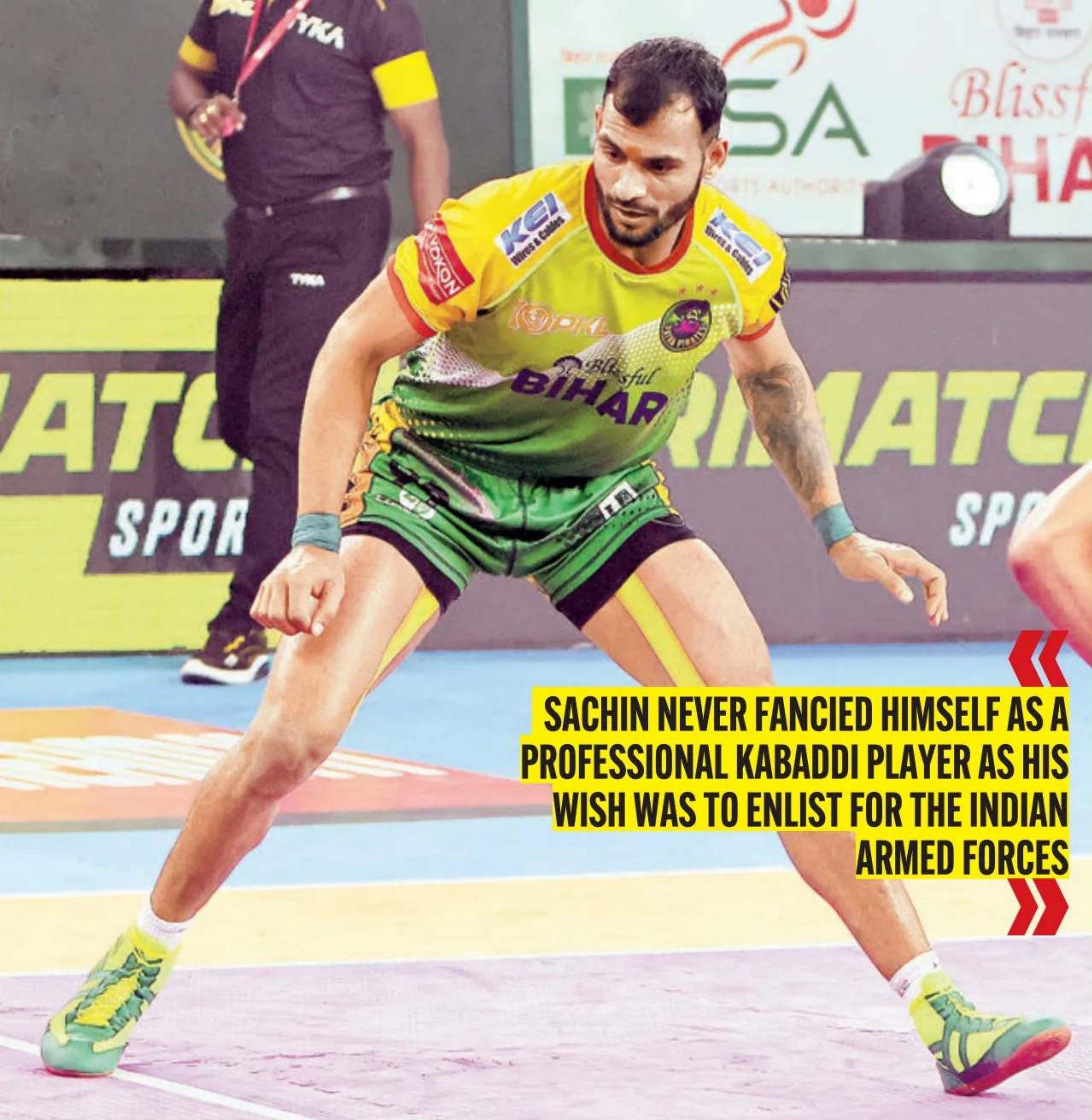




SACHIN NEVER FANCIED HIMSELF AS A PROFESSIONAL KABADDI PLAYER AS HIS WISH WAS TO ENLIST FOR THE INDIAN ARMED FORCES

Gorgan for the Asian Kabaddi Championship. He rubbed shoulders with seasoned pros like Ajay Thakur, Rahul Chaudhari, Deepak Niwas Hooda, Nitin Tomar, and Surender Nada.

Pro Kabaddi comes calling

Despite two triumphant sojourns in Iran, Sachin missed out on a Pro Kabaddi spot in 2016 due to a technicality. While he had been signed by the Telugu Titans, he couldn't participate due to the New Young

Programme, which requires players to be at least 18 years of age or older.

"I was playing on a contract basis for ONGC under coach Manpreet Singh saab (who currently coaches the Haryana Steelers in PKL). We participated in numerous tournaments in Chennai and Kanyakumari. Manpreet paaji saw what I could do and assured me that he would pick me up at the auction," Sachin remembers.

Manpreet was then the coach of one of the new franchises in the PKL

Dependable: A striking feature of Sachin's career so far has been his efficacy in being his team's crisis man.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

— Gujarat Fortune Giants (now Gujarat Giants). He kept his word and secured Sachin for a sum of Rs. 36 lakh.

The teenager quickly got off the blocks to become Gujarat's poster boy ahead of more experienced players like Mahendra Singh Rajput and